

DESIGN REFERENCE

Color system

Anchors: #abd037 Chartreuse · #3e4a64 Slate blue



#abd037

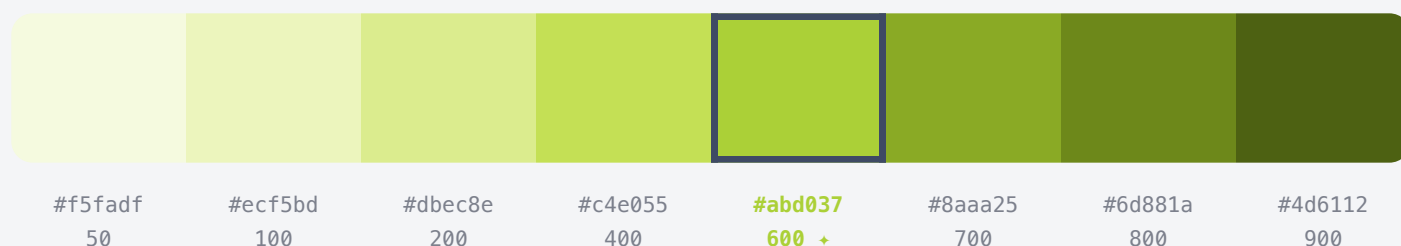


#3e4a64

01

Lime ramp

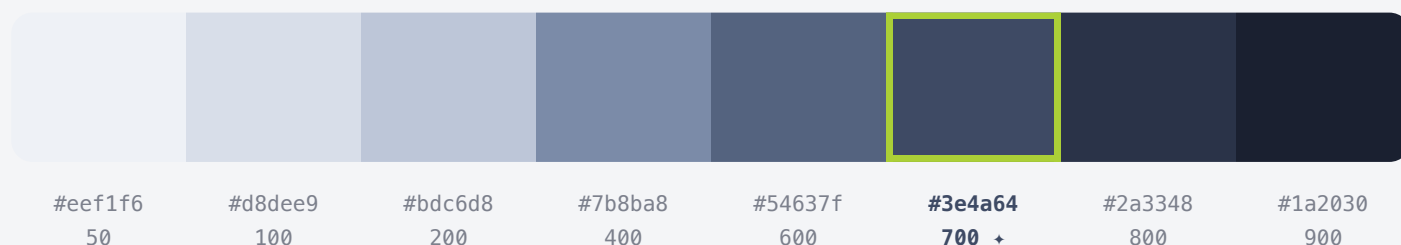
Built from the chartreuse anchor. Use for primary actions, accents, highlights, and ecological data visualizations (abundance, density, presence).



02

Slate ramp

Built from the slate blue anchor. Use for navigation, headers, dark panels, and neutral data series.



03

Neutral ramp

For all structural elements — page backgrounds, cards, borders, and body text. Slightly blue-tinted to complement the slate anchor.

50	100	300	500	700	900
#f4f5f7	#e8e9ec	#b8bac2	#7c808c	#4a4d57	#1e2028
Page background	Borders, dividers	Placeholder text	Secondary text	Body text	Headings

04

Color roles

How specific stops are assigned to UI components across the site.

	ROLE	HEX	USAGE
	Navigation / header	#2a3348 · Slate 800	Primary nav bar, footer background
	Dark section panels	#3e4a64 · Slate 700	Hero sections, feature blocks, sidebar dark variant
	Primary CTA	#abd037 · Lime 600	Main buttons, active nav indicators, key badges. Use #1e2028 text on top of this.
	Callout / highlight box	#f5fadf bg · #abd037 border	Tinted surface for tips, highlights, featured content
	Page background	#f4f5f7 · Neutral 50	Overall site canvas
	Card surface	#ffffff + #e8e9ec border	Content cards, panels, modals
	Heading text	#1e2028 · Neutral 900	All h1–h4
	Body text	#4a4d57 · Neutral 700	Paragraph text, descriptions



Muted /
secondary
text

#7c808c ·
Neutral 500

Captions, labels, metadata, timestamps

05

Graph colors — categorical

For charts with multiple named series (e.g. multiple species on a line chart, grouped bars). Use in order — C1 first, then C2, and so on. Each series must also use a unique dash pattern and point shape, not just color.

C1 Chartreuse #abd037 Anchor · featured / primary series solid · circle	C2 Slate #3e4a64 Anchor · secondary series dashed · square	C3 Sienna #e07540 Warm contrast dotted · triangle	C4 Teal #2da89e Cool accent dash-dot · open circle
C5 Violet #9460c8 5th series long dash · diamond	C6 Amber gold #d4a020 6th series long dots · cross	C7 Rose #c44e7a 7th series dash-dot-dot · x	C8 Sky blue #5c8fc4 8th series short dots · inv. triangle

✓ DO

- Use C1 and C2 for the most important 1–2 series
- Pair every color with a unique dash pattern and point shape on line charts
- Show both the color swatch and pattern in the legend
- Keep series count to 4 or fewer when possible

✗ DON'T

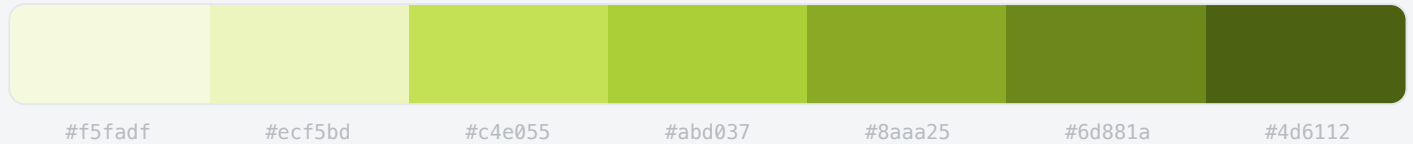
- Distinguish series by color alone — some users are colorblind
- Use C5–C8 unless you have 5+ series
- Mix these categorical colors into the sequential or diverging palettes
- Use the semantic colors (red, green) for data series

Graph colors — sequential

For maps, heatmaps, and choropleth charts where a single variable increases from low to high.

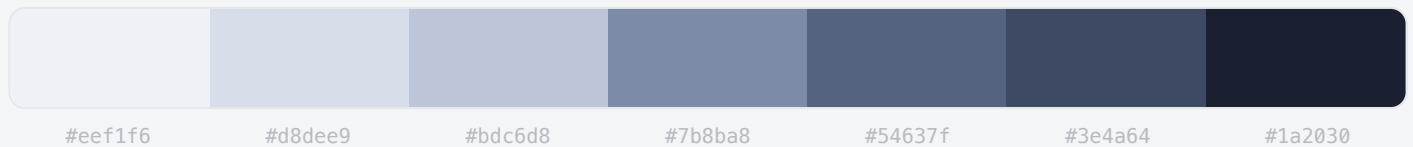
Lime scale — ecological & biological data

Use for: abundance, sighting density, species overlap probability, presence index



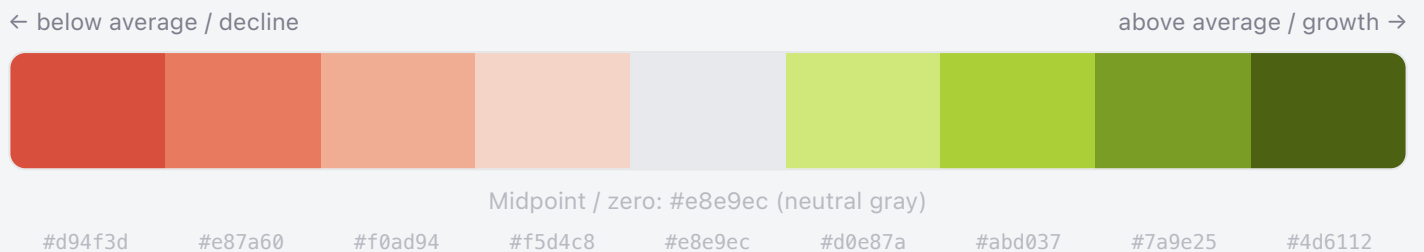
Slate scale — neutral ordinal data

Use for: elevation bands, time bins, survey effort, rank order



Graph colors — diverging

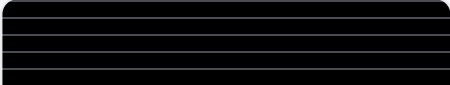
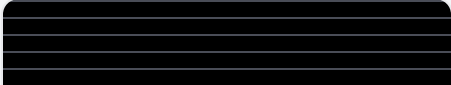
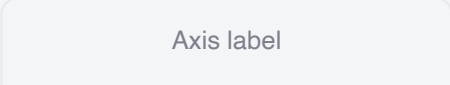
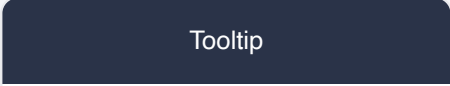
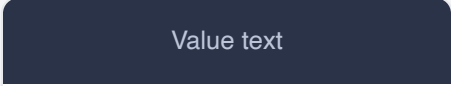
For data that has a meaningful midpoint — things that can be either above or below a baseline. Sienna on the low end, neutral in the middle, lime on the high end.



Use for: population change year-over-year, deviation from historical average, above/below baseline comparisons.

Chart chrome

Non-data elements — axes, grids, tooltips. These should be subtle and never compete with the data.

 Grid lines <code>rgba(74,77,87, 0.12)</code> Very subtle, 0.5px stroke	 Zero / baseline <code>rgba(74,77,87, 0.30)</code> Slightly stronger than grid	 Axis labels & ticks <code>#7c808c · 11px</code> Neutral 500 — same as muted text
 Tooltip background <code>#2a3348 · Slate 800</code> Matches nav/header	 Tooltip body text <code>#bdc6d8 · Slate 200</code> Softer than pure white	 Hover highlight / crosshair <code>#abd037 · Lime 600</code> 1px stroke on hover state

09

Semantic colors

For UI status states only — form validation, alerts, badges. Do not use these as data series colors in charts.

 Error <code>#d94f3d</code> Form errors, destructive actions	 Warning <code>#d48a1a</code> Caution states, incomplete	 Success <code>#3e9463</code> Confirmations, completed	 Info <code>#2f7ec4</code> Informational notices, links
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